Stress learning guide

Managing stress & change (Children's MH Week).

Use the invented learner. You may say, point, draw, type or use your usual aid. A scribe can write your exact chosen words and read them back. Personal details are not needed.

Invented change

An invented learner hears that two familiar tasks will happen in a different order. Their shoulders feel tense, their stomach feels fluttery and it is hard to focus. They think, “I will get every part wrong.” The tasks are familiar and school staff can explain the first step. Nothing unsafe has happened.

In your book

Link the three story clues to the map or a list. Explain why clues are not proof. Try a fairer story thought, then choose a safe strategy and a support role. Keep the short story work you make during practice; no long new task is needed.

Model

The learner might be responding to the changed plan. Tense shoulders, a fluttery stomach and poor focus are possible signs; they can have other causes. A fairer thought is, “The order changed. I know parts of these tasks. I can ask for the first step.” The learner can try a gentle strategy and ask staff to make the plan clear.

Trial choices

Breathing, reframing and movement are all offered in the calm lesson. You can try an adapted option, observe or pass. No one has to feel stressed. A strategy need not make someone feel better to show learning.

Review

Use one next step on fictional work and reply in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. The self-check is about learning. Keep your personal plan with you; it is not collected.

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Staff learning record

RSE-LAUNCH-S1-W02-E1 · Thursday 14 January 2027 · P4

Use a work code, not a name. Record fictional learning only. No private plan, symptoms, feelings, health/family history or disclosure details. Actual concerns go in the separate school safeguarding record.

Record	Staff entry
Work reference and date	
Chosen tier and usual mode	
Stress meaning and clue limits	
Three story body map or list links	
Fictional fairer thought and known fact	
Breathing tried adapted observed passed or not observed	
Reframing tried adapted observed passed or not observed	
Movement tried adapted observed passed or not observed	
Safe choice adaptation and help by role	
Usual aids and access	
Adult content prompts	
Learning self check if offered	
First try one NS and own reply	
Next teaching opportunity and saved work	

No participation choice is failure. Do not infer symptoms, diagnosis, health or strategy effectiveness. Record not observed honestly. E requires saved actual work; R requires Voice and Audience, one NS and own response. Any disclosure goes to safeguarding lead through school procedure. Maintain the agreed supervised pause route.

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